INDIA–BRAZIL

A Partnership Shaping the Global South

Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva's recent visit to India highlighted the deepening strategic convergence between two leading voices of the Global South. Marking his fifth presidential visit, Lula's engagements in New Delhi combined economic diplomacy with symbolic gestures of cultural warmth, reinforcing a relationship increasingly described as a partnership of equals.

Addressing the India–Brazil Economic Forum, Lula emphasised the structural similarities between the two countries, noting that India and Brazil share comparable developmental needs and ambitions. "There is a great deal of similarity between Brazil and India—in our attitudes and in our needs," he observed, stressing that this common ground makes it easier to set joint targets and strengthen business partnerships. He encouraged deeper collaboration between entrepreneurs and invited Indian companies to expand investments in Brazil.

A key theme in Lula's remarks was the distinctive nature of India–Brazil relations. Unlike negotiations with some advanced economies, he said, engagement with India is marked by mutual respect rather than hierarchy. In a pointed observation, Lula remarked that Brazil was "not dealing with a coloniser" in its discussions with India, suggesting that negotiations are guided by balance rather than dominance. With India, he noted, "it is not the strongest force that prevails," underscoring a diplomatic ethos based on equality and shared aspirations.

The visit also reflected a personal dimension. Lula said he was deeply moved by the musical tributes arranged during the state dinner, recalling how he had organised a similar gesture for Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the latter's visit to Brazil. The exchange symbolised the warmth and mutual regard that characterise bilateral ties.

Lula also highlighted India's influence on Brazil's economic policy. Reflecting on his first visit in 2005, he recalled being struck by India's foreign exchange reserves, then nearing $100 billion. The experience prompted Brazil to strengthen its own reserves as a safeguard against volatility. Brazil later built reserves of about $360 billion, transforming itself from a debtor to a creditor of the International Monetary Fund—a shift Lula described as a turning point.

Situating the visit within Brazil's broader diplomatic strategy, Lula said his current term focuses on restoring the country's global standing. Over the past three years, Brazil has opened more than 500 new export markets, reflecting renewed economic diplomacy.

Lula arrived in India on February 18 and participated in the India AI Impact Summit on February 19–20. His visit followed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's state visit to Brasília in July 2025, signalling renewed momentum in a partnership anchored in shared development goals, economic cooperation, and a vision for a more balanced global order.





The results of President Lula's state visit to India speak for themselves. More than fifteen cooperation agreements and business contracts were sealed and new investments in India as well as in Brazil were announced by global players such as TCS, Mahindra and IFFCO, Fomento, Embraco and Vale, among others. Additional joint ventures between Brazilian and Indian companies were also hammered out. Altogether, these results will boost the political, economic and technological weight of our strategic partnership, in areas that are vital to ensuring sustainable and resilient development for our societies, such as energy, defense, agriculture, health, and digital infrastructure.

Among those areas, I highlight the agreement that will connect our national missions for the development of rare earth and critical mineral supply chains; the new partnerships between public and private institutions for joint research, development and innovation in pharmaceuticals; and the launch of a broad digital partnership. New business ventures include a Memorandum of Understanding between Adani and Embraer, the world's third largest aircraft manufacturer, to establish a final assembly line for civil aircrafts in India; and the doubling of TCS of its delivery centre in Brazil.

These gaming-changing results do not reflect a concentrated effort to deliver under the aegis of hasty transactionalism. They are the fruits of a mature bilateral relationship rooted in mutual trust, built over nearly eight decades between two countries with no historical, geopolitical, or geoeconomic liabilities. Over the last three years, more than 150 missions exchanged by our business communities have turned potential economic complementarities into new flows of trade and investment. Our bilateral trade, by the way, hit a new record, surpassing the USD 15 billion mark.

Taking a broader view, our relations have been gaining greater economic and technological breadth in a complex international geopolitical scenario, in which finding safe paths to socioeconomic development requires a mixture of creativity and cautious boldness.

Most importantly, exchange of visits between our senior leaders are becoming increasingly frequent: President Lula's visit took place less than a year after Prime Minister Modi's visit to Brazil, the Brazilian National Security Advisor's visit to India, followed by our Vice President.

In addition to expanding the bilateral outlook of our strategic partnership, President Lula's visit reinforced the traditional coordination between Brazil and India in international fora, for a more democratic and inclusive global governance, for the benefit of the entire humanity. In this spirit, President Lula was one of the first heads of State/Government to confirm his presence at the AI Impact Summit, joining Prime Minister Modi's call for the democratization of artificial intelligence, so that it becomes an instrument of inclusion and empowerment, particularly for the Global South.

President Lula's state visit to India demonstrated that the political vision and business dynamism of both countries are converging to take Brazil-India relations to a new level.

— Kenneth Felix Haczynski da Nobrega
Ambassador of Brazil